Reading Practice – Passage 1: The History of Tea

HaDiNa English Center · Tài liệu lưu hành nội bộ

Tea has been consumed in China for thousands of years. According to legend, the emperor Shen Nong discovered it in 2737 BC when leaves from a wild tree blew into his pot of boiling water. For centuries, tea was valued mainly as a medicine before it became a daily drink.

During the Tang dynasty, tea culture spread throughout the country, and the writer Lu Yu produced the first book devoted entirely to tea. Japanese monks who studied in China later carried seeds home, where tea became central to Zen Buddhist practice.

Tea reached Europe in the early seventeenth century through Dutch traders. At first it was so expensive that only the wealthy could afford it, and it was often kept in locked boxes. By the nineteenth century, however, the British had established vast plantations in India and Sri Lanka, and tea became the national drink of Britain.

Questions 1–5: TRUE / FALSE / NOT GIVEN

1. Tea was first used as a medicine. 2. Lu Yu was an emperor of the Tang dynasty. 3. Japanese monks brought tea seeds from China. 4. Dutch traders sold tea at low prices. 5. Britain imported most of its tea from China in the 1900s.